

SOC Incident Report

Tier 1 Analyst Triage — SSH Authentication Log Review
Analyst: John | Date: 2026-09-11 | Log Source: auth.log (server)

1. Observation

During routine review of SSH authentication logs, multiple failed login attempts were identified within a short time window, consistent with automated brute-force / credential-stuffing behavior. Two source IP addresses were flagged for repeated failed authentication attempts against privileged usernames.

2. Evidence

Timestamp	Source IP	Username	Result
Sep 10 08:12:01	185.220.101.4	root	Failed
Sep 10 08:12:03	185.220.101.4	root	Failed
Sep 10 08:12:05	185.220.101.4	admin	Failed
Sep 10 08:13:40	102.89.44.10	john	Accepted
Sep 10 09:02:11	45.155.205.77	root	Failed
Sep 10 09:02:15	45.155.205.77	root	Failed
Sep 10 09:45:00	102.89.44.10	john	Accepted

Summary counts: 5 failed login attempts, 2 successful logins. Failed attempts originated from 2 distinct external IPs: 185.220.101.4 (3 failures) and 45.155.205.77 (2 failures).

3. Analysis

185.220.101.4 generated three failed attempts within four seconds, cycling between the usernames 'root' and 'admin'. This rapid username-switching pattern is not consistent with human typing behavior and is a strong indicator of automated brute-force or credential-stuffing activity. 45.155.205.77 shows a similar but smaller-scale pattern: two failed attempts against 'root' four seconds apart, again suggesting scripted login attempts rather than a legitimate user error. By contrast, the two successful logins for user 'john' from 102.89.44.10 were not preceded by any failed attempts from that IP, and the access pattern is consistent with routine, legitimate use. No further action is recommended for this account/IP pairing unless additional context (e.g., GeoIP mismatch, unusual login time) emerges.

4. Recommended Action

- Block/deny 185.220.101.4 and 45.155.205.77 at the firewall or fail2ban level pending further review.
- Escalate to Tier 2 for deeper investigation, including WHOIS/GeoIP lookup on both IPs and a

check for similar patterns against other hosts in the environment.

- Continue monitoring the 'root' and 'admin' accounts for further brute-force attempts.
- No action required for the john / 102.89.44.10 login activity at this time; classified as benign.

This report was produced as part of a self-directed SOC Tier 1 training exercise analyzing simulated SSH authentication logs on Kali Linux.